

This section provides learners with a knowledge and understanding of the structure and functions of the transport and gas exchange systems in mammals and terrestrial plants.

Learners will gain an appreciation of the need for mass transport systems and the significance of the surface area to volume ratio in multicellular organisms. The mass flow of materials within mammals and the exchange of molecules are studied in the context of the need to maintain a high metabolic rate.

Technological advances enable the activity of the heart, circulation and gas exchange systems to be monitored. Learners will be able to apply their knowledge of physiology to the interpretation of data on vital measurements of heart function, blood pressure and pulmonary ventilation. The importance of timely emergency treatment in both cardiac and respiratory arrest is also studied.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.

2.2.1 The heart and monitoring heart function

Learning outcomes	Additional guidance
<i>Learners should be able to demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:</i>	
(a) the need for a mass transport system in mammals	To include references to a high basal metabolic rate, being multicellular and the significance of surface area to volume ratio. <i>M0.3, M4.1</i>
(b) (i) the internal and external structure of the mammalian heart (ii) the examination, dissection and drawing of the mammalian heart	PAG2 HSW3, HSW4, HSW5, HSW6, HSW8
(c) the cardiac cycle	To include the role of the valves and the pressure changes occurring in the heart and associated vessels.
(d) how heart action is initiated and co-ordinated	To include the roles of the sino-atrial node (SAN), atrio-ventricular node (AVN), purkyne tissue and the myogenic nature of cardiac muscle (no detail on hormonal and nervous control is required at AS level but at A level this is covered in 5.3.1(b)).
(e) practical investigation(s) into the factors affecting heart rate	To include the effect of exercise. <i>M0.1, M0.4, M1.2, M1.3, M1.11, M2.3, M2.4, M3.1, M3.2</i> PAG10 HSW3, HSW4, HSW5, HSW6

(f) the effect of heart rate on cardiac output

To include calculations based on heart rate and stroke volume.

M0.1, M0.4, M1.2, M1.3, M1.11, M2.3, M2.4, M3.1, M3.2

PAG10

HSW3, HSW4, HSW5, HSW6

(g) the measurement and interpretation of pulse rate, to include the generation of primary data and the use of secondary data

M0.1, M0.4, M1.2, M1.3, M1.10, M1.11, M3.1, M3.2

PAG10

HSW3, HSW4, HSW5, HSW6

(h) the use and interpretation of an electrocardiogram (ECG)

To include tachycardia, bradycardia, S-T elevation and fibrillation.

M3.1

HSW3, HSW5

(i) the emergency treatment given to a person suffering a suspected heart attack or cardiac arrest.

To include the first-aid treatment for a heart attack and cardiac arrest

AND

the use of a defibrillator following cardiac arrest.